

SUN RYUNG PARK

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Research interests: Comparative political economy; green industrial transformation; strategic state capacity; energy security; resource governance; Northeast Asia

EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Ph.D., Political Science

2025

Dissertation: Race to Go Green: Three Pathways in Green Industrial Revolution.

Committee: Yves Tiberghien (supervisor), Kristen Hopewell, and Gyung-Ho Jeong.

Korea University

M.A., Political Science and International Relations

2016

Thesis: The Chinese Government's Consolidation Policy over Strategic Resources Industries: Why Has It Abolished the Export Restrictions on Rare Earth?

Korea University

B.A., Political Science and International Relations

2013

Double major in Politics, Economics, and Law; magna cum laude.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

"Energy Security in the Indo-Pacific: Strategic Implications for Canada." *Journal of Military and Strategic Studies*. **Forthcoming**.

"Reframing Growth: Elite Paradigms and Korea's Green Pivot." *Pacific Affairs* Vol. 99, Issue 1 (2026): 25-44.

"Green Industrial Policy Race in Asia Quickens despite US Retreat." *East Asia Forum Quarterly* Vol. 17, Issue 3 (2025): 13-15. (with Yves Tiberghien)

"Centralization through Consolidation: Restructuring the Chinese Rare Earth Industry." *Peace Studies* Vol 25, Issue 1 (2017): 117-154. (with Joo-Youn Jung)

"Between the Local Governments and Producers: Why Rare Earth Smuggling Persists in China." *Journal of International Politics* Vol. 20, Issue 2 (2015): 101-131. (with Joo-Youn Jung)

Book Chapters

"Green Technology Transition from Above: Drivers and Constraints in Japan and Korea." *In Decarbonization in East Asia: Challenges of Green Energy Transition*, edited by Lewis et al. University of Washington Press. **Forthcoming**. (with Yves Tiberghien).

"The Green Tech Race Is a Story for the Entrepreneurial State." *In The EU Indo-Pacific Bid: Sailing Through Economic and Security Competition*, edited by Filippo Fasulo, 99-129. Milan: Italian Institute for International Political Studies (ISPI), 2023. (with Yves Tiberghien).

"Weaponization and Vulnerability in China's Rare Earths Hegemony." *In World Politics* 27, edited by Joo-Youn Jung, 243-295. Seoul: Center for International Studies, Seoul National University, 2017. In Korean.

CURRENT RESEARCH PROJECTS

Green industrial transformation in Korea, Japan, and Taiwan

Solo-authored comparative manuscript combining fuzzy-set qualitative comparative analysis and process tracing. Manuscript in preparation for submission.

China's rare-earth industrial policy and strategic supply chains

Collaborative manuscript on state restructuring, weaponized resources, and energy security. Manuscript in preparation.

When Green Meets Security

Postdoctoral research project on the resilience and reconfiguration of green industrial strategies under geopolitical and energy security pressures.

ACADEMIC, RESEARCH, AND PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Asia Pacific Foundation of Canada | Vancouver

Senior Research Specialist

May 2025-present

Comparative policy research on Northeast Asian industrial transformation, economic security, critical-mineral supply chains, clean energy, and emerging technologies for government, policy, and public audiences.

School of Public Policy and Global Affairs, the University of British Columbia | Vancouver

Research Fellow

Sept. 2026-present

Affiliated with the Centre for Japanese Research, contributing to the Centre's academic programming and mentor SPPGA students conducting fieldwork for the second-year Global Policy Project (GP2) on energy security in Japan and Taiwan.

China Institute, University of Alberta | Remote

Contract Researcher

Nov. 2025-present

Commissioned research and policy report on the international expansion of China's electric-vehicle industry and its strategic, industrial, and supply-chain implications.

Taipei School of Economics and Political Science, National Tsing Hua University | Hsinchu

Visiting Research Fellow

Mar.-June 2026

Field research on Taiwan's green industrial and technological transformation; research seminar, guest lecture, and master's thesis committee service.

Centre for Japanese Research, Institute for Asian Research, UBC | Vancouver

Academic Lead and Research Assistant

Sept. 2022-June 2025

Led an international initiative on digital and green technology transitions in the Indo-Pacific, including agenda development, contributor coordination, and working-paper editing.

National Chengchi University | Taipei

MOFA Taiwan Fellow and Visiting Scholar

Feb.-May 2024

Field research and expert interviews on Taiwan's net-zero and energy-transition policies.

Pacific Trade and Development (PAFTAD)

Young Scholars Fellow

2023

Developed and presented original research on green industrial policy at the PAFTAD 41 Conference in Seoul.

Centre for Korean Research, Institute of Asian Research, UBC | Vancouver

IAR-CKR Research Fellow

2021-2023

Research and expert interviews on South Korea's renewable-energy policies.

School of Public Policy and Global Affairs, UBC | Vancouver*Liu Scholar*

2021-2022

Research project and policy report on green-technology supply chains.

Department of Political Science, UBC | Vancouver*Research Assistant*

2020

Quantitative research on South Korean legislative politics for a co-authored paper presented at the 2022 APSA Annual Meeting.

East Asia Institute | Seoul*Research Associate / Program Officer*

Jan.-May 2017

Policy research and international workshop coordination for the National Endowment for Democracy-funded Asia Democracy Research Network project.

The Korea Society | New York*Research Intern*

2016

Conducted research on China's foreign policy and U.S.-ROK alliance dynamics, authored a working paper, and supported public-diplomacy programs through a grant-funded internship.

Korea University | Seoul*Research Assistant*

2013-2016

Supported Korea-China research through data collection and the coordination of academic forums and international conferences in Tokyo and Beijing.

SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

MOFA Taiwan Fellowship, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Taiwan	2024
PAFTAD Young Scholars Fellowship, Pacific Trade and Development (PAFTAD)	2023
Dean of Arts Graduate Student Research Award, UBC	2023
Liu Scholar Award, UBC School of Public Policy and Global Affairs	2023
Graduate Student Research Grant, UBC	2022
SSHRC-Funded Travel Grant, Department of Political Science, UBC	2022
Faculty of Arts Graduate Award, UBC	2022-2023
Four-Year Fellowship, UBC	2017-2021
R. Howard Webster Foundation Fellowship	2017
Brain Korea 21 Plus Graduate Scholarship, Korea University	2013-2015
Samgu Foundation Full Scholarship (merit-based), Korea University	2013

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of British Columbia*Instructor*

July-Aug. 2025

Designed and taught Power, Markets, and the Planet: Global Political Economy in the Digital and Climate Era, a four-week intensive undergraduate course.

University of British Columbia*Teaching Assistant*

2018-2022

Courses in Quantitative Methods, Political Analysis, Chinese Politics, Japanese Politics, and the Honours Seminar.

Korea University

Teaching Assistant

2014-2016

Courses in Chinese Politics and the Political Economy of East Asia, including tripartite e-learning courses with Chinese universities.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

"Energy Transition under Geopolitical Pressure: Comparing Korea and Taiwan's Search for Energy Security." National Tsing Hua University, Hsinchu, Taiwan. 2026.

"Energy Security in the Indo-Pacific: Implications for Canada." Thompson Rivers University, Kamloops, Canada. 2025.

"Reframing Growth: Elite Paradigms and Korea's Green Pivot." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition, Vancouver, Canada. 2025.

Roundtable panelist, Canada-Korea Series, Canadian Global Affairs Institute, Ottawa, Canada. 2024.

"Green Transformation in Japan from a Comparative Perspective." University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan. 2023.

"Race to Go Green: Green Entrepreneurial State in East Asia." PAFTAD 41 Conference, Seoul, Korea. 2023.

"Presidentialized Partisanship, Personal Ideology, and Constituent Interests." American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Montreal, Canada. 2022.

SELECTED POLICY REPORTS & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

"Chinese Electric Vehicle Industry Going Global." China Institute, University of Alberta. **Forthcoming.**

"[Canada and South Korea Need a Critical Minerals Partnership that Delivers.](#)" *Policy Magazine*, 2026.

"What Ottawa's TKMS Submarine Decision Means for Canada-South Korea Ties." *Asia Pacific Foundation of Canada (APFC)*, 2026.

"How Canada and Taiwan Can Team Up on AI, Chips, and Critical Minerals." *APFC*. 2026.

"The Case for Canada-Japan Co-operation on Semiconductors and Supply Chains." *APFC*. 2026.

"South Korea Looks to Canadian Energy to Fuel Its AI Ambitions." *APFC*. 2025.

"[Canada-Republic of Korea Defence and Security Co-operation.](#)" *APFC*. 2025.

"An Entrepreneurial State in Green Transition: Korea's Energy Security and Canada-ROK Co-operation." *Canadian Global Affairs Institute*, 2023.

Media: Expert commentary for Bloomberg Television, Channel News Asia, Global News, RTVE, and Mediapart; guest on Energy Security Cubed.

SELECTIVE ACADEMIC SERVICES

Taipei School of Economics and Political Science, National Tsing Hua University

Master's Thesis Committee Member

March 2026-present

Centre for Korean Research, UBC

Executive Member

Sept. 2026-present

METHODS AND LANGUAGES

Methods: Comparative case analysis; process tracing; expert interviews; fuzzy-set qualitative comparative analysis (fsQCA); quantitative analysis

Software: R; Python

Languages: Korean (native); English (fluent); Mandarin (reading proficiency for research)

Last updated: September 18, 2026